

VER. 26.1

Authenticity

Greaves

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1. Implementation

The document has been created and approved by the General Assembly of 09.11.2024.
The document and its rules have been implemented since the 2025 season.

2. Definition

“Greaves” is the term used to describe all lower leg protections.

Types of Greaves:

- **1-Panel Greaves (Half-Greaves)**
  Made of 1 plate of metal forged to the shape of the lower leg.
  Attached by a leather strap at the back of the calf.

- **2-Panel Greaves (Cased Greaves)**
  Made of 2 plates of metal built to protect the lower leg at 360°.
  The plates are built with hinges and attached by a leather strap at the inner side of the lower leg.

- **3-Panel Greaves**
  Made of 3 plates of metal attached with leather.

- **3/4 Greaves**
  The front side of the lower leg is protected by a metal plate.
  The outside of the lower leg is protected by a half-plate of metal, leaving the inner side of the lower leg unprotected.

- **Splinted Greaves**
  Metal plates riveted to a leather base.
  The plates are alternately outside and inside the leather.

- **Brigand Greaves**
  Metal plates riveted to a fabric base.
  The plates are covered by the fabric.

- **Eastern Greaves**
  Due to very few historical sources, it is allowed to use eastern stylization of European Greaves.
  Allowed designs are displayed in the document “Eastern Armors.”

3. General Requirements

Historical Basis: Must be based on historical sources.

Anatomical Shape: Must have the anatomical shape of the lower leg.

Proportions: Must reproduce the proportions based on historical sources.

Malleolus Protection: Must protect the malleolus bone.

4. One Panel Greaves (Half-Greaves)

4.1. Historical Sources and Datation

The 1-panel greave is the earliest form of lower leg protection available for knights, originating in the early 14th century.

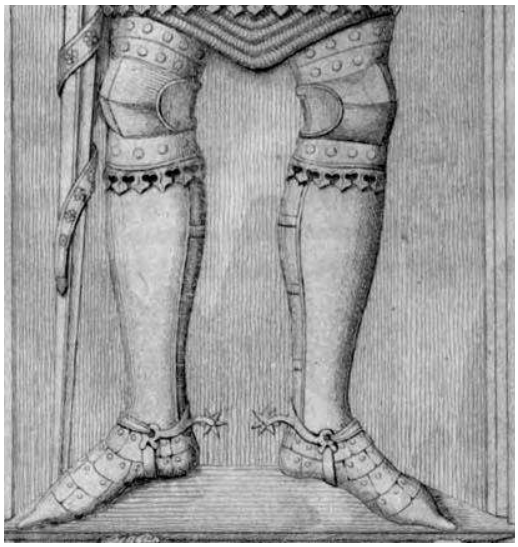
They are **Approved** for **14th century** and **Transitional armors**.

They are **Denied** for **15th century armors**.

4.2. Historical References



Crucifixion, Niederhaslach – 1360, France



J. von Falkenstein – 1365, Germany

4.3. Specific Requirements for One Panel Greaves (Half-Greaves)

They must follow the General Requirements (see Section 3 above).
The entire front of the lower leg must be covered by the greaves.

4.4. Examples of Approved Reproductions



Picture from Forge of Svan ©



Picture from Age of Craft ©

4.5. Examples of Denied Reproductions

Non-anatomic shape



Pictures from The Medieval Things ©

5. Two Panels Greaves (cased greaves)

5.1. Historical Sources and Datation

2-panel greaves, also known as **cased greaves**, were the most common form of lower leg protection from 1370 to 1600 and later. They provided superior protection for competitors by covering the entire lower leg from all sides.

They are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.





Metropolitan Museum of Arts - 1450



Brescia - 1470/1480 - Italy

5.2. Specific Requirements

They must follow the General Requirements (see Section 3 above).

2-panel greaves are **Approved** if worn with the **adequate armor style from the 15th century**.

2-panel greaves at the **bottom** or **top** of the greaves are **Denied** for 15th century armor.

5.3. Examples of Articulation

Fully enclosed Greaves (with heel-protection) appear in the **late 15th century only.**

They are **Denied** for **14th century** and **Transitional armors.**

Example of fully enclosed Greaves:



5.4. Examples of Approved Reproductions





5.5. Examples of Denied reproductions

Non-anatomic design Greaves with riveted ankle part (not based on historical sources)





Pictures from The Medieval Things ©

6. Three Panels Greaves

6.1. Historical Sources and Datation

3-panel Greaves are mainly represented in Germany from 1360 to 1380. They consist of one front panel and two side panels, articulated by leather straps.

They are **Approved** for **14th century** and **Transitional armors**.

They are **Denied** for **15th century armors**.

6.2. Historical Example



Sir Burchard von Steinberg – 1376, Germany

6.3. Specific Requirements

They must conform to the General Requirements (see Section 3 above).

The side panels must protect both sides of the lower leg, including the malleolus bone.

The panels can be articulated with leather straps or a piece of leather between each panel.

It is **Allowed** to extend the width of the side panels to cover the back of the calf, despite this not being based on historical proportions.

It is **Allowed** to use hinges instead of leather despite it not being documented by historical sources.

6.4. Examples of Approved Reproductions

Side panels that are based on historical proportion



Pictures from Age of Craft ©



Picture from The Medieval Things ©

Wider size panels for safety



Picture from Medieval Extreme ©

6.5. Examples of Denied Reproductions

Side panels lack of shaping

Does not adequately protect the malleolus bone, rule 1.2.4









Pictures from The Medieval Things ©

7. Three Quarters Greaves

7.1. Historical Sources and Datation

3/4 Greaves first appeared in the 15th century.

They are **Approved** for **Transitional** and **15th century armors**.

They are **Denied** for **14th century armors**.

7.2. Historical Example



Metropolitan Museum of Art – 1550, Italy

1.1. Specific Requirements

They must conform to the General Requirements (see Section 3 above).
The side panels must cover at least half of the back of the calf.

1.2. Examples of Approved Reproductions



Picture from Age of Craft ©



Picture from The Medieval Things ©

8. Splinted Greaves

8.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Splinted Greaves are represented in Europe from 1350 to 1380. They consist of metal plates riveted to a leather base.

They are **Approved** for **14th century** and **Transitional armor.**

They are **Denied** for **15th century armor.**

8.2. Historical Examples



Louis Thys – 1365, Belgium



G. von Schwarzburg – 1349, Germany

8.3. Specific Requirements for Splinted Greaves

They must conform to the General Requirements (see Section 3 above).

They must be made of metal plates with the following features:

- rectangular shape,
- firmly riveted to a leather base,
- plates must be riveted alternatively inside and outside the leather base,
- plates must conform to the anatomical shape of the lower leg.

8.4. Examples of Approved Reproductions





Picture from Medieval Extreme ©

8.5. Examples of Denied Reproductions

Fantasy designs and Non-anatomical shape







9. Brigand Greaves

9.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Brigand Greaves are represented in Europe from 1350 to 1380. They consist of metal plates riveted to a fabric base.

They are **Approved** for **14th century** and **Transitional armors.**

They are **Denied** for **15th century armors.**

9.2. Specific Requirements for Brigand Greaves

They must conform to the General Requirements (see Section 3 above).

They must be made of metal plates with the following features:

- rectangular shape,
- firmly riveted to a leather base,
- plates must be riveted inside the fabric, not outside,
- plates must conform to the anatomical shape of the lower leg.

9.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions



Picture from Forge of Svan ©

9.4. Examples of Denied reproductions

Non-anatomical shape



Picture from The Medieval Things ©

10. Other Denied Items

10.1. Four or five Panels Greaves

Those types of Greaves are not based on historical sources.

To get an approved piece, the 4th plate can be removed. The closest alternative would be the 3-panels greaves.

10.2. Examples of Denied Reproductions





Picture from The Medieval Things ©

11. Changelog

Below, we will keep track of all the changes made over the lifetime of this document. This way, all our members can see how the documents are changing over time.

January - 2026 (V. 26.1)
Formatting redone for consistency and readability. Except points listed below, no content changes.
Add: “1. Implementation” (and subsequent modification of all Title numbers in the document)
Clarification:
- Split of “1. Definition and general requirements” in “2. Definition” and “3. General Requirements”.

This split doesn’t have an impact on the content of the rules.

March-2025 (V2025.03)
- Formatting: Overall grammar and formatting
- add: 8.1: the 4th plate can be removed
- add: 4.5: Side panels lack shaping, Does not adequately protect the malleolus bone, rule 1.2.
- add: 3.5: Greaves with riveted ankle part (not based on historical sources)

December-2024: -add
Document has been created